

Vittorio Maria Ruffo

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Education

Frankfurt School of Finance & Management

Frankfurt, Germany

PHD IN FINANCE AND MASTER IN BUSINESS RESEARCH AND ANALYTICS

September 2022 - present

- Main research interests: Asset Pricing, Option-Implied information, Decentralized Finance, News and Textual Data
- Advisor: Prof. Grigory Vilkov

Collegio Carlo Alberto and University of Turin

Turin, Italy

SECOND LEVEL SPECIALIZING MASTER IN FINANCE, INSURANCE AND RISK MANAGEMENT

September 2021 - July 2022

- Merit based full tuition waiver

University of Verona

Verona, Italy

MASTER IN BANKING AND FINANCE - QUANTITATIVE FINANCE TRACK

September 2019 - September 2021

- Final Grade: 110/110 with honours
- Supervisor: Prof. Alessandro Buccioli
- Thesis in Econometrics “*Personality and investment choices: an analysis on Australian panel data*”

University of Verona

Verona, Italy

BACHELOR IN ECONOMICS AND BUSINESS

September 2016 - September 2019

- Final Grade: 110/110 with honours
- Supervisor: Prof. Elena Giaretta
- Thesis in Business Management “*Tourism between sustainability and innovation: the “Glamping” phenomenon*”

Working Papers

Market Efficiency in Prediction Markets: A Comparison with Derivatives, with M. Fabi, R. Marfè, and L. Schoenleber [link to paper]

Abstract: We study pricing efficiency in decentralized prediction markets by comparing Polymarket prices with option-implied prices derived from derivatives. We study pricing efficiency in decentralized prediction markets by comparing Polymarket prices with option-implied prices derived from derivatives. We analyze nearly 5,000 Polymarket contracts written on Bitcoin (BTC) and Ethereum (ETH), two assets for which prediction-market contracts and liquid derivatives markets coexist. We find that Polymarket prices closely track option-implied prices, but systematic deviations remain: they are concentrated in tail and barrier contracts, vary with sentiment, volatility, demand, and market frictions, and imply more probability mass on extreme price movements. To guide our empirical investigation, we introduce a parsimonious limits-to-arbitrage model that formalizes equilibrium behavior in decentralized prediction markets.

Factor Dispersions, with D. Gerchik, L. Schoenleber, and G. Vilkov [link to paper]

Abstract: Dispersion strategies capture the difference in variance dynamics between a basket and its components. Even though smart-beta indices intend to load heavily on a particular factor, factor dispersions based on such baskets are exposed to risks of other factors and idiosyncratic variances. Analyzing factor dispersions through a linear factor model and equicorrelation representations, we recover driving forces behind dispersion dynamics and work out an attribution of a dispersion risk premium. As a balanced combination of systematic and idiosyncratic variance components, dispersion and its risk premium provide signals about future changes in systematic and alpha-based investment opportunities.

- Winner of the CBOE - The Options Institute - S&P Dow Jones Indices Dispersion Research Grant

Work in Progress

Firm-level News Networks, with C. Dim and G. Vilkov

Dispersion Markets and the Price of Relative News, with D. Gerchik, L. Schoenleber, and G. Vilkov

Conference and Seminar Presentations (* presented by coauthor)

2026 Decentralized Finance & Crypto Workshop at Scuola Normale Superiore (Pisa), 5th Workshop on Decentralized Finance (DeFi) in Association with Financial Cryptography 2026 (St. Kitts)*, XXVII Workshop on Quantitative Finance (Bergamo), Tech 4 Finance #3: AI and Blockchain (Paris), Designing DeFi (D² 2026) (New York), Frontiers in DeFi 2026 (Berlin)*, 3rd Structured Retail Products and Derivatives Conference (Hagen), Future Finance Fest (3f) (Amsterdam)*, 8th Future of Financial Information Conference (Frankfurt).

2025 Second Liverpool Workshop in Option Markets (Liverpool), 14th International Moscow Finance Conference (Moscow)*, 2025 Global AI Finance Research Conference (Hong Kong), DeFi Workshop 2025 (Grenoble)*.

2024 Second Bonn-Frankfurt-Mannheim PhD Conference (Bonn), World Federation of Exchanges Research Webinar (online)*, Cboe Risk Management Conference 2024 (Snowbird)*, 2024 FMA Conference on Derivatives and Volatility (Chicago).

Teaching and Work Experience

- 2026- **Lecturer, Corporate Finance (Bachelor)**, Frankfurt School
- 2025 **TA in Portfolio Optimization in Continuous Time (Master, Prof. Francesco Sangiorgi)**, Frankfurt School
- 2025- **Lecturer, Introduction to Economics and Finance (High school)**, Associazione Lagrange
- 2025- **Lecturer, Python Bootcamp (Master)**, Teaching rating (4.1/5), Frankfurt School
- 2024- **TA in Financial Products & Modelling (Master, Prof. Grigory Vilkov)**, Frankfurt School
- 2024- **TA in Corporate Finance (Bachelor, Prof. Larissa Schaefer and Prof. Yigitcan Karabulut)**, Frankfurt School
- 2024 **RA for Quantitative Asset Management, Prof. Francesco Sangiorgi**, Frankfurt School
- 2023 **TA in Portfolio Management (Master, Prof. Paula Cocoma)**, Frankfurt School
- 2022 **Teacher, Data Analysis Laboratory with R**, University of Verona
- 2021 **TA in Financial Econometrics (Master, Prof. Alessandro Buccioli)**, University of Verona
- 2021 **TA in Statistics (Bachelor, Prof. Marco Minozzo)**, University of Verona
- 2020-2021 **TA in Business Management (Bachelor, Prof. Elena Giarretta and Prof. Angelo Bonfanti)**, University of Verona

Scholarships

- 2022 **Doctoral Scholarship** Frankfurt School of Finance & Management
- 2021 **Merit based full tuition waiver** Collegio Carlo Alberto

Computer Skills

Python, Matlab, R, Stata, SQL, Java, Latex, Adobe Lightroom and Photoshop, Phase One Capture One

Additional Information

Languages: English (Fluent), Italian (Native speaker)

Interests: Photography, Hiking, Cooking